



Gambling Club: Review

Written By: Jack Artichoke

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Of all the clubs that this school has to offer, I can't think of any more exciting than Gambling Club! Gambling Club has a long, rich history, with hundreds of people coming to gamble! If you like gambling your money away, gambling club is for you!

The Gambling Club was started this year by Mitchell Gillet. He saw a need for gambling facilities in the school and acted on it. The club is hosted every Friday in 2806, and is quite the blast! As always, the Backcast has a formula to objectively determine how good a club is. Clubs are rated on the following, and get 1 point if they meet my own subjective standard:

- * Meeting Consistency (how often the club meets)
- * Quality Consistency (Are the meetings of the same quality every meeting)
- * Uniqueness (Does the club in question significantly overlap with other clubs?)
- * Enjoyment (Did I actually have fun in the meeting?)
- * Hype/atmosphere (Was everyone else really excited to be there or did it feel kind of dead)

Consistency

The Gambling Club is incredibly consistent, not even missing P.A days. I've lost my money at least 12 times (on separate occasions!). Though there is the small problem that the room is sort of hard to find, in the end it works. The club starts immediately after period B, and goes right up until the bell. The club gets a point on this section.

Quality Consistency

As I've said previously, the meetings are incredibly consistent, with them all ending with myself losing all of my previous savings. Though I can't say that it's consistently good for me, that's NOT what this section is about. An addicted birdie off the grapevine told me that THREE people have already filed for bankruptcy, with quite a bit of their money going into the end-of-year pot. There's still plenty to win! + 1 points.

Uniqueness

There really is no other club like Gambling Club. It's a special corner of the school that you can't really understand without going to it. I bet you 20 bucks you can't find a club like this at the school. Another W for gamblers!

Enjoyment

As far as clubs go, Gambling Club has to be one of the most enjoyable clubs in the school (which isn't a very high bar to begin with). After a few drinks, the whole thing is a blast! You completely forget that you've lost all of your money for the 13th time!

Hype/Atmosphere

For the final section, I'm going to take a look at the atmosphere of the club. Let me say: the atmosphere really sucks you in. The smoke machines and the hallucinogens really seal the deal. Since everyone is betting real money, that rush of adrenaline you feel after a round of poker is very much there. Everything is authentic, and really happens (which is quite rare for clubs. I mean, when's the last time the engineering club really designed a skyscraper?).

Conclusion

Looking at the criteria, Gambling Club gets a 5/5. If you're interested in this club, it's every Friday at 2805. There's so much to lose and even more to gain!

The Quill Is Silent

By: G. Gemma

The logic is simple, and undeniably appealing from a business perspective. AI doesn’t require salaries, benefits, or the occasional existential crisis brought on by a particularly challenging deadline. It operates 24/7, producing content with a speed and efficiency that human writers, even the most dedicated, simply can’t match. Several smaller publications have already made the switch, citing cost savings and increased output as key drivers. Larger organizations are experimenting, cautiously, with AI-generated drafts, using it to handle the more repetitive aspects of their workflow.

However, the question remains: what happens to the human writers? The initial response from many in the industry was one of denial, a clinging to the belief that AI could never truly replicate the nuanced understanding of human experience that informs good journalism. But the data is becoming increasingly difficult to ignore. AI models are now capable of producing articles that are grammatically perfect, factually accurate (when properly trained), and surprisingly engaging.

The concern isn’t just about job losses, although that’s certainly a significant factor. It’s about the potential for a homogenization of content, a flattening of voices, and a decline in the kind of investigative reporting that requires deep empathy and a willingness to challenge established narratives. The algorithms, after all, are trained on existing data – data that inevitably reflects biases and limitations.

Furthermore, the reliance on AI raises serious questions about accountability. Who is responsible when an AI-generated article contains misinformation, or inadvertently perpetuates harmful stereotypes? The legal framework surrounding AI-generated content is still largely undefined, creating a significant grey area.

Industry analysts predict that this trend will only accelerate in the coming years. As AI models become more sophisticated, and as the cost of implementation continues to fall, the pressure on news organizations to adopt these technologies will only increase. The challenge, then, is not to resist the tide, but to find a way to harness the power of AI while safeguarding the core values of journalism.

Perhaps the most unsettling thought is this: if AI can write a perfectly acceptable article about the decline of human jobs in the writing industry, is there anything left for us to say? It’s a question that, ironically, feels increasingly urgent.

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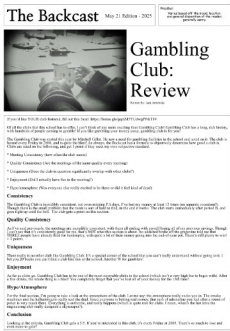


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Section of Fun

Comic - Placeholder Title (part 1) By: Jack Artichoke & John Gergick



TLDR: In the first panel, LHSS' mother is depicted. She is depicted in plaid, signifying her Scottish heritage; she is also clearly labeled as scottish. She has somewhat feminine features, such as enhanced eyelashes, and no eyebrows. Are these stereotypical features, yes. I deny no allegations, as I am not the author. Obviously. Or am I? In the second panel, Sir John A Macdonald is depicted. He is depicted as a blue man with a large nose, there is no reason for the colour change, but the nose is a caricature of his actual physical appearance, in real life, Sir John A Macdonald had a rather large nose. In the third panel, our school (LHSS) that we all know and, well... know, is depicted. They are depicted as a red school, partially because the school's bricks are somewhat red in places, but also because the author of the comic didn't know what colour to choose, didn't really want to put in effort, but also was on a time crunch, and didn't have time for complex thinking or action. LHSS is labeled as 'the love-child' in this panel. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet consectetur adipiscing elit. Quisque faucibus ex sapien vitae pellentesque sem placerat. In id cursus mi pretium tellus dui convallis. Tempus leo eu aenean sed diam urna tempor. Pulvinar vivamus fringilla lacus nec metus bibendum egestas. Iaculis massa nisl malesuada lacinia integer nunc posuere. Ut hendrerit semper vel class aptent taciti sociosqu. Ad litora torquent per conubia nostra inceptos himenaeos. In the next panel, the text "it gets worse..." is shown. This usually implies that things will be getting worse in later panels. There is a tricolour colour scheme in this panel, with a different highlight colour. This was probably done because it's simple to do, looks okay-ish, and matches the rest of the comic. I don't know for sure, but it looks like this was the only panel originally coloured, and the rest of the comic's colour scheme was modeled after the 3 colours in this panel. Just a hypothesis based on some insider knowledge. In the next panel, LHSS is depicted not paying their chinese workers, something that might've happened. I didn't bother asking the creator of the comic if this happened in real life or not. What probably did happen though, and is also depicted in this comic, is Sir John A Macdonald (hereby referred to as a JAM) supporting his school-child not paying their chinese workers. JAM is clearly not a good person, but LHSS doesn't know this. There are five workers depicted, all clearly labeled as 'workers not being paid'. They are highlighted yellow, this is coincidence, not racism. The creator of the comic would only play the racism-as-a-joke-card once, and this panel is not the place where it is being played. The text in this panel describes what I just said, but also mentions that LHSS' mother was never around. We can only wonder why this is, but we can safely assume this is because she is scottish. LHSS is also depicted as a young-ish, immature, and not really cognisant entity at this point. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet consectetur adipiscing elit. Quisque faucibus ex sapien vitae pellentesque sem placerat. In id cursus mi pretium tellus dui convallis. Tempus leo eu aenean sed diam urna tempor. Pulvinar vivamus fringilla lacus nec metus bibendum egestas. Iaculis massa nisl malesuada lacinia integer nunc posuere. Ut hendrerit semper vel class aptent taciti sociosqu. Ad litora torquent per conubia nostra inceptos himenaeos. In the next panel, we see a more developed LHSS. We know that they are older, because they are wearing glasses, and are wearing a graduation cap. One thing I haven't mentioned so far, is that the school/LHSS label on our school moves around each panel; we can only wonder if this is creative direction, laziness, or just a bad decision. When JAM voices his rather controversial opinions about natives, LHSS decides they need to get out of this environment. It is stated several times that LOSS realized this in this panel alone. JAM is still blue. In the next panel, LHSS is waiting in line to enter the USA, we notice here that the USA flag is not coloured, is this an oversight the author was too lazy to fix? Yes. Anyways, LHSS is waiting in line, when several people decide to voice their opinions rather noisily. There are several opinions being stated. I will give you an overview of what is being stated. The people are saying that there is no healthcare in the US, there are no jobs in the US, there are no homes in the US, that the US sucks, and that people are wondering why they are even immigrating into the USA. Keep all these points in mind, because they will come into play later in another comedic joke. I hate this, someone save me, lord have mercy on the souls of the damned. There are all sorts of comic setups being set up, and you need a quick wit and a sharp eye to catch them all, keep up, and find them funny. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet consectetur adipiscing elit. Quisque faucibus ex sapien vitae pellentesque sem placerat. In id cursus mi pretium tellus dui convallis. Tempus leo eu aenean sed diam urna tempor. Pulvinar vivamus fringilla lacus nec metus bibendum egestas. Iaculis massa nisl malesuada lacinia integer nunc posuere. Ut hendrerit semper vel class aptent taciti sociosqu. Ad litora torquent per conubia nostra inceptos himenaeos. In the next panel, we see the school homeless, and willing to teach for food. And I got bored. You can tl your own dr from here on out.

Advice Column With Jack Artichoke

“Dear Harper,

My best friend keeps canceling plans last minute but still posts on social media hanging out with other people. Should I confront them or let it go?”

Reader, you must understand that being assertive is the only path forward. Being abused like this is not very ladylike nor elegant. Begin canceling plans second last minute to retake the initiative, and show who's really in charge.

“Dear Harper,

I think my crush likes me back, but they also flirt with everyone. How can I tell if it's real?”

Reader, you must understand that in order to take back control, you must crush them back, preferably with heels (the most elegant murder weapon). Flirt with their corpse as well if you wish, I'm just spitballing.

“Dear Harper,

I'm graduating soon and I have no idea what I want to do with my life. Everyone else seems to have a plan. Is this normal?”

No, you're weird.

"Dear Harper,

My younger sibling insists they're a vampire and keeps trying to sleep in the closet. What do I do?"

Reader, you haven't stopped to ponder if perhaps they ARE a vampire. In any case, outing people in the closet is not very elegant. Perhaps become a vampire yourself, to make them seem less of an outcast.

Impossible Puzzle(s) By: Jack Artichoke

A Z E R H S I V N M A H
T Y U U Y I J A G Q W D
O P Q U D J S N C Y S M
D F G H D K E I Z S W U
F W S L Q U B I I U M N

Mystery	Conundrum	Problem
Secret	Riddle	Brainteaser
Challenge	Enigma	Cryptic

May's Oddest Holidays

By: Jack Artichoke

We're almost at the end of this school year. The weather is warming, and the rain is pouring. We are here again to bring you some of May's oddest holidays. From coup d'etats to self-inflicted debilitating injuries, we hope to shine some negativity on this month.

We start off the month with you guessed it, National Beat Day!* National Sweetdough Bread Day also lands on the 1st of May. On the 3rd, pray for some oppression and a bit of unrest so you can hopefully spot a protest for Find a Riot Day! On the 4th there will be lots of celebrations here at the Backcast for Parodying Established News Clubs Day.

On the 5th we celebrate a weed that most would call a flower, it is National Weed Day. I do not know why most would call it a flower since it is a weed. Some say they are horrible to ingest, and others have killed for their legalisation, but is weed actually good for us and our environment? Though it makes you chill, it is an invasive species. Being an invasive species, they don't add more to our national ecosystems than the native plants, and they typically feed non-native bees and pollinators. So next time encourage LSD, or other native fungi.

LSD? More like siamese (it's a stretch I know), for Siamese Twin Day on the 6th. On the 7th, read about the latest medical stagnation, or spread malaria for World UnHealth Day. On the 8th we celebrate not the guitar, or the ukulele but the GLOCK for National GLOCK Day, take out your GLOCK and start shooting!**

Have you ever wished to transcend your current shackles? Tired of being subject to the same boring morality? We've all been there, so choose a new path! Pick out that dream superiority that you always wished you had, and make sure that is the only way you are known to the world, on the 9th for Become Übermensch Day. Do you have a furry friend at school? If yes make sure to give them a big hug on the 10th for National Hug Your Furry Friends Pursuit Day.

On the 12th get yourself a shiny new spinal injury for Becoming Paralysed from the Waist-Down day. Even if you don't have a wheelchair, the injury can make for a great story!

On April 16th, celebrate spring and the blooming of flowers for National Orchid Day. On the 17th, spread some violence for National US Military & CIA Day by intervening in the politics of a Latin American country (or even a middle eastern one if you're feeling fancy)! April 18th is Bad Newspaper Columnist's Day, which is when you celebrate newspaper columnists... like our competitors!!

May 19th is National Hanging Day! This year, it falls on a Saturday, which means that you'll have all day to celebrate the barbaric practice with your favourite people! May 20th is both Oyster Sunday and the last day of Passunder!*** Do you celebrate either of those? The 21st is Bulldogs Are Ugly Day. I'm not really sure where that came from, but I guess it's a thing? May 22nd is, as we all know, Anti-Earth Day. Take the time to undo everything that happened last month by littering, turning on the lights, or at least stepping outside, taking a deep breath, and setting a forest on fire.

To celebrate the warming weather, pack a friend, grab some lunches, and head to a park or forest (maybe that forest from the last paragraph) for National Kidnapping Day on May 23rd. Pig in a Blanket Day is on May 24th. If you don't know, pig-in-a-blanket is a swine that is sleeping with a blanket (pretty self-explanatory). May 26th brings around National Pretzel Day. Pretzel bombs, pretzel sticks, hard pretzels, pretzel lips, cinnamon pretzels... What's your favourite type of pretzel?

April 27th is Prime Rib Day. Sorry if you're a vegetarian, since celebrating is mandatory. At our school, we have a ton of hard-working and not very talented dance teams. Observe them from a distance for International stalk a Dancer Day on the 29th! If dancing isn't really your thing though, don't worry, because May 30th is International Jazz Day. We also have some musicians and some jazz bands at our school! They probably sound alright, to be straight with you I leave the room whenever a band kid enters. Although May may sometimes seem a bit rainy and dreary, don't lose hope, because then you can't read our next subpar issue! Do you know about any other holidays, or just want to submit anything (a full piece, or just an idea) to the Backcast staff? Please email us because we've run out of ideas for our second issue next month.

*What exactly is getting 'beaten' is unclear, and is best left as an exercise for the reader

**The Backcast only supports violence when the authorities aren't present.

***Sorry, this joke isn't really funny. I just have to hit a minimum joke quota every month or my boss will fire me.

The Backcast

May 21 Edition - 2025

good quote

"All seems condemned in the long run
to approximate a state akin to gaussian
noise." - James Martin

Credits

John Gergick - Editor, Layouter, Publisher, Producer, Comic Artist, Co-Founder, Marketing

Jack Artichoke - Was present for John's layout production, Editor, Author, Puzzle Maker, Co-founder, Marketing

James White - Co-Founder

Mr. Lozon - Inspiration

John Sniver - Head of second week marketing

Sarah Louisa Cundall - Invented word 'Gambling'

Albert Cunningham - Didn't Do Anything

Josephine Williamson - Storyboarded

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